

Guidance on Calculation of Master's Student Workload

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1. Purpose and Legal Basis

This guidance defines how the workload of master's students is calculated, recorded, and communicated, and sets out the institutional obligations that support master's-level education - research supervision, staffing, internships, and thesis preparation. It is issued under the oversight of the Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs for use by faculties, departments, research supervisors, and the Educational-Methodological Department.

The guidance rests on two legal instruments:

1. Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 824, dated December 31, 2020, and its Annex 1, the "Regulation on the procedure for introducing the credit-module system into the educational process in higher educational institutions" (the "Regulation") - the source of the credit-hour and workload calculation rules below (Sections 3-4).
2. Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 36, dated March 2, 2015, "On approval of the Regulation on the Master's Degree Program (Magistratura)" - the source of the master's-specific obligations for educational-methodological, research, and pedagogical work, internships, traineeships, and thesis preparation (Sections 5-7).

Together, these instruments mean a master's student's workload is defined, calculated, and communicated in credits under ECTS principles, while the research, pedagogical, and practical activities that generate part of that workload are organized under Resolution No. 36.

2. Key Definitions

Term	Definition
Credit	A unit of measurement of the learning load a student masters in a subject, based on learning outcomes; expressed in whole or fractional numbers.
Study load (workload)	The number of hours a student needs to achieve the expected learning outcomes, across classroom activity and independent work - for a master's student, including research, pedagogical, and practical components.
GPA (Grade Point Average)	The credit-weighted average of a student's grades across a program (formula in Section 4).

Term	Definition
Research supervisor	The academic assigned to guide a master's student's research, thesis, and calendar work plan.
Calendar work plan	The master's student's schedule of educational-methodological, research, pedagogical, and practical activities for a period, developed with the research supervisor and formally approved (Section 7).
Educational-Methodological Department	The university unit responsible for the curriculum, subject catalog, syllabi, and credit/workload consistency.

3. Workload Calculation for Master's Students

Under the Regulation (Chapter 4, item 15), a master's student's workload - including classroom hours and the types of independent study assigned - is calculated in credits under ECTS principles, using the following parameters:

Hours per credit. 1 credit corresponds to an average of 25-30 academic hours of study load, set by the university council within this range.

Classroom vs. independent-work split (master's). 30-40% classroom hours and 60-70% independent-work hours, excluding internships and the graduation (thesis) project - those are calculated separately under Resolution No. 36 (Sections 5-6).

Credit load per period. 30 credits per semester; 60 credits per academic year.

Total credits required for the degree:

Minimum program duration	Total credits
1 year	60
2 years	120

Academic year structure. Up to 36 weeks: 30 weeks of instruction, 2 weeks for subject-selection registration, and 4 weeks for certification (examination) periods, unless the university council sets a different schedule.

Departments and research supervisors must express the credit value of each component of a master's student's calendar work plan consistently with these ratios.

4. GPA Calculation

GPA is the credit-weighted average of a student's grades across all subjects/modules in the reporting period (Regulation, Chapter 2, item 4):

$$GPA = \frac{K_1U_1 + K_2U_2 + K_3U_3 + \dots}{K_1 + K_2 + K_3 + \dots}$$

where:

- **K** - the number of credits allocated to each subject/module;
- **U** - the grade the student earns in each subject/module.

Worked example. A master's student completes three modules in a semester: 6 credits at a grade of 4.5, 4 credits at 4.0, and 5 credits at 3.5.

$$GPA = (6 \times 4.5 + 4 \times 4.0 + 5 \times 3.5) / (6 + 4 + 5) = (27 + 16 + 17.5) / 15 = 60.5 / 15 = 4.03$$

GPA also governs progression from one course to the next: the university council sets the minimum passing GPA within the range 2.4-3.0. A master's student who does not meet it repeats the course; one with academic debt is not expelled, but repeats only the subjects owed, at the corresponding contract fee.

5. Master's-Specific Activities Under Resolution No. 36

While Sections 3-4 fix how a master's student's credits and GPA are calculated, Resolution No. 36 governs how the underlying activities that generate that workload are organized. It covers:

- **Educational-methodological work** - coursework and structured study within the master's program.
- **Research work** - the investigative activity that builds toward the thesis.
- **Pedagogical work** - teaching practice components of the program, where assigned.
- **Internships and traineeships** - practical placements with partner organizations.
- **Thesis preparation** - including any experimental or field component of the thesis.

Each of these is still expressed and credited under the ECTS-based calculation in Section 3 (classroom and independent-study hours per credit); Resolution No. 36 sets the institutional conditions that make them possible to deliver and supervise, described in Section 6.

6. Institutional Obligations Under Resolution No. 36

To organize master's-level educational-methodological, research, and pedagogical work, internships, traineeships, and thesis preparation, the university must:

1. **Ensure appropriate scientific and pedagogical staffing** - assign professors and associate professors whose specialization matches the program.
2. **Provide the educational-methodological and material-technical base** needed for theoretical, laboratory, and research work.
3. **Establish formal agreements with relevant organizations** for student internships and for the experimental components of master's theses.

4. **Involve leading scientists and specialists** from the Academy of Sciences, sectoral research institutions, and foreign institutions, engaged on an hourly-wage basis.

These obligations sit alongside, and support, the credit-based workload calculation in Section 3: they are what allows a department to actually deliver the classroom and independent-study hours a master's program requires.

7. Calendar Work Plan and Reporting

Development and approval. Each master's student's calendar work plan - covering their educational-methodological, research, pedagogical, and practical activities for the period - is developed jointly with their research supervisor and approved by the vice-rector (or deputy director) for academic affairs.

Reporting cycle:

Who	Reports to	Frequency
Master's student	Department meeting	Monthly
Head of department	Faculty's educational-methodological council	End of each semester

The department head's semester report covers the calendar work plan's implementation across the department's master's students, giving the faculty's educational-methodological council oversight of how workload commitments made under Section 3 are actually being met.

8. References

- Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 824, "On measures to improve the system related to the organization of the educational process in higher education institutions," Tashkent, December 31, 2020.
 - o Annex 1: Regulation on the procedure for introducing the credit-module system into the educational process in higher educational institutions, Chapter 2 (Basic concepts, item 4: GPA formula), Chapter 4 (item 15: credit-hour and workload calculation).
- Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 36, "On approval of the Regulation on the Master's Degree Program (Magistratura)," March 2, 2015.

Companion material: this guidance complements the university's general "Guidance Directive: Student Workload under the Credit-Module System," which covers bachelor's and master's workload together; this document focuses specifically on master's-level calculation and organization.